

copies the function. A dotted line will appear around the selected cell. Right-click on any other cell, and then click to 'Paste' into that cell. You can continue right-clicking on other cells to paste the formula into other cells. When you are finished copying, double click anywhere on the worksheet to turn off the copy/paste function.

This will copy the function to the new cell(s). The function will also automatically be edited so that it takes the values from the appropriate cells. For example, if you copy the function from cell B6 in the example above and paste it into D6, the function will automatically change from '=SUM(B2:B5)' to '=SUM(D2:D5).'

3.4 Playing With Numbers, Labels And Formatting

3.4.1 Numbers In Excel

Entering a number into Excel is simple enough—just select the cell and enter the number into it! However, there are several things you need to remember—for example, Excel treats certain numbers as dates. Here's a walkthrough of what you need to keep in mind.

3.4.1.1 The Number Of Digits

Beyond 11 digits, Excel switches the display to scientific notation. For example, 123456789012 will be displayed as 1.23E+11, where the '1.23' can be anything based on what you've formatted the cell as. Also, Excel only accepts 15 significant digits—so whatever you enter beyond 15 digits is treated as zeroes. Thus 12,345,678,901,234,567,890 is treated as 2,345,678,901,234,500,000 (and displayed in scientific notation).

3.4.1.2 Displaying Long Numbers

If you enter a number that doesn't seem to fit in a cell, it will be displayed with hashes ('#####'). To correct this, simply increase the column width.